

Haydn met the requirements of the court for operas and concerts to entertain the household and its guests, who sometimes included the Austrian empress, Maria Theresa. His operas are now largely forgotten, but the orchestral and chamber music he wrote at this time founded the Classical style in Western music. He established the four-movement symphony as the standard orchestral work and virtually invented the string quartet and piano trio. In his hands, formal musical structures, such as the sonata and rondo, revealed their rich potential for variety of expression and dramatic effect.

Later critics have identified a *Sturm und Drang* (storm and stress) period in his music of the early 1770s, allegedly reflecting a wider cultural turn toward troubled emotion. But Haydn did not fit the profile of an anguished Romantic; he was a man of sanguine temperament who peppered his works with musical jokes and surprises. He knew how to evoke grave sadness, gentle melancholy, and aching beauty, but his works always resolved into a bracing display of energy and joy in life.

International reputation

Haydn labored in relative isolation at the Esterháza palace, but enjoyed mounting fame in the wider world as his works filtered into print. From 1779, the Esterházys allowed him to publish for his own profit and he began to write for the international market. His Paris symphonies, written in 1785–1786, were commissioned for performance in the French capital.

He was allowed to spend more time in Vienna, where he met Mozart, forming a relationship of mutual admiration and